

# Drake Thorne

Network Platform Engineer | Haymarket, NSW

[contact@drakethorne.com](mailto:contact@drakethorne.com) | [drakethorne.com](https://drakethorne.com) | [linkedin.com/in/drakethorne](https://linkedin.com/in/drakethorne) | [github.com/drake-thorne](https://github.com/drake-thorne)

## SUMMARY

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Network Platform Engineer with 4+ years of experience designing, automating, and operating network and infrastructure across on-premises and cloud environments. Experienced with building scalable automation platforms – Ansible, Python, and Terraform over AWS, EKS, and NetBox – using Git-based CI/CD, turning manual network and infra workflows into repeatable, self-service systems.

## EXPERIENCE

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### Network Platform Engineer | Nine Entertainment

Aug 2024 – Present

- Developed and delivered the company's first Mist-based network automation, building frameworks for multiple full-site EVPN-VXLAN spine-leaf fabrics across Juniper QFX/EX and Fortinet platforms, leveraging Juniper Mist, Ansible, Python, and GitHub Actions. Automated traffic draining, BGP policies, peering, route maps, ESI-LAG, IRB/VRF management, and port allocation.
- Developed and maintained Ansible automation frameworks and API-driven workflows (REST API/GraphQL) integrating NetBox, Infoblox, LogicMonitor, ServiceNow, Cisco ISE, and Cisco Catalyst Center, enabling scalable infrastructure management across 1500+ network devices while reducing manual toil.
- Built a CI/CD pipeline adopted across 100% of the team's OpenTofu repositories, managing AWS, Cloudflare, and NetBox resources on self-hosted Actions runners on EKS - showing planned diffs on PRs and applying on merge.
- Engineered repeatable microservices deployments on Amazon EKS via Helm charts and Kubernetes manifests. Included NetBox, Oxidized, Ansible AWX, and self-hosted Docker Registry with pull-through cache.
- Developed event-driven, serverless AWS pipelines connecting Basware and Microsoft D365, using AWS Lambdas written in Golang. Managed infrastructure such as EventBridge, SQS, API Gateway, S3, and IAM roles via OpenTofu.
- Built and maintained Docker images for development containers and production execution environments using Ansible Builder and Git-based CI/CD workflows via GitHub Actions, publishing multi-architecture ARM64/AMD64 images to Amazon ECR.
- Led the end-to-end migration of enterprise DHCP infrastructure from Windows DHCP Server to Infoblox across all sites, developing Ansible automation for IPAM migration, DHCP scope provisioning, and VXLAN gateway updates. Provided post-migration operational support.
- Automated Amazon RDS lifecycle management processes using Ansible, reducing manual database provisioning and maintenance effort by approximately 50%.
- Designed and deployed automated ERSPAN unicast monitoring workflows integrated with ExtraHop, increasing network traffic visibility to approximately 80% of RX traffic.
- Diagnosed and resolved pod/node failures, performance bottlenecks, and cluster resource constraints across containerised workloads on Amazon EKS, using Grafana, Vector, and ClickHouse for observability.

### Systems Administrator | Fin Design + Effects

Apr 2023 – Aug 2024

- Designed and delivered a centralized monitoring and telemetry platform across 500+ nodes using Graylog, Zabbix, Grafana, and Slack integrations, improving observability and reducing incident response times.
- Developed Ansible-based automation for Linux fleet management across 50+ nodes, including configuration management, Cron jobs, patching, and operational maintenance.
- Built and implemented secure remote access infrastructure using Duo MFA, RADIUS/Active Directory authentication, L2TP/IPsec VPNs, Apache, and Nginx reverse proxy technologies.
- Managed hybrid infrastructure environments spanning Windows Server, VMware, TrueNAS, Google Cloud Platform, and Linux systems, supporting business-critical production workloads.
- Designed, deployed, and maintained Layer 2 and Layer 3 network infrastructure across Brocade and Cisco platforms, including VLANs, VRFs, LAG/LACP, NAT, and routing instances.

- Implemented network security controls through ACL management, Barracuda firewall administration, and PowerShell-based encryption automation to strengthen infrastructure security posture.

## Systems Administrator | Nielsen

Oct 2022 – Mar 2023

- Managed large-scale Active Directory (users, security groups, group policy, DNS, DHCP), and Cisco ACLs/VLANs across the corporate environment.
- Configured Zabbix monitoring and alerting for infrastructure health, and automated operational tasks with PowerShell.
- Rebuilt and patched Windows Servers (2008-2019) and workstations across on-prem and private data centre sites via iDRAC, with SIEM-based log analysis and 24/7 on-call support.

## EDUCATION

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### Diploma of Information Technology | Macquarie University

Graduated 2022

WAM: 81.875 (Distinction)

Academic Integrity Certification | Macquarie Association of Computing Students (MACS)

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

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**Programming:** Python, Bash, PowerShell, REST APIs/GraphQL

**Automation & IaC:** Ansible, AWX, Terraform/OpenTofu, Git, GitHub Actions

**Containers & Platforms:** Docker, Kubernetes, Helm, Linux

**Cloud:** AWS (EKS, EC2, ECR, RDS, S3)

**Networking:** NetBox, Cisco (IOS, NX-OS, ISE, Catalyst Center), Juniper (Junos, Evo, Mist), FortiGate, Brocade, EVPN-VXLAN, BGP

**Monitoring & Operations:** Grafana, ClickHouse, LogicMonitor, Infoblox, Wireshark, Nginx, Apache